

Lynn Hunt May Pitch Miners Opener Friday

Lefty Lynn Hunt, ace of coach Andy Cohen's staff for two years, will, no doubt, get the call either Friday or Saturday when the University of Texas at El Paso Miners open their 1969 baseball season at Dudley Field against University of Albuquerque.

Hunt, a stylish senior, was 7-4 last season with a 3.86 earned run average after posting an 8-3 mark and a brilliant 1.73 ERA as a sophomore.

Friday's single affair is the beginning of a 49-game schedule, the most ambitious ever undertaken by Cohen's Miners. Saturday's session is a twin bill.

Cohen feels his pitching staff will be the strongest part of his ball club which opens Western Athletic Conference warring for the first time this spring.

"If our hitting does come around," Cohen says, "we could have a good ball club. I feel our pitching, right now, is the strongest part of our team."

One of the items which concerns the Miners task master is the lack of lefthanded power. Only Larry Currie, a JC import, hits from the wrong side of the plattre.

The infield should give Cohen's pitchers confidence if Currie comes around at first base. Danny Blanco, a three-year letterman, will be at third, Juan Sandoval will be at second and Ron Rush, a handy untily infielder, proba-



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bly will handle the shortstop chores.

Cohen can call upon a number of promising fly chasers to patrol the outer garden. Among these will be John Miller, converted from first base, Mike Ward, Rich Butler, Sam and Bill McLelland, John Murphy, etc.

Ron Hix, a hard hitting senior, will be behind the plate backed up by such people as footballer Dick Daugherty, Rick Witt and Dick Meyer.

It is the pitching that gives Cohen some degree of confidence. Besides Hunt, Cohen will have the services of Marc Bombard, Bill Diesselhorst, Ron Jones, Jesse Lujan, Harry Milner, Bill Onick, Ron Peterson, Don Wilson and Terry Witt.